

Football YouTube Automation Playbook

A practical agent-led workflow for creating football essay videos with less manual work.

1. The Channel Operating Model

The channel should run like a repeatable production system. Each video starts with a high-potential football angle, then moves through research, scripting, clip sourcing, voiceover, edit planning, thumbnail packaging, and upload preparation.

The agent handles the repetitive and research-heavy work. The creator stays focused on approvals, taste, final judgment, and publishing decisions.

Role	Main responsibility	Typical output
Agent	Research topics, validate demand, draft scripts, find clips, create edit plans, and prepare metadata.	A complete video package with script, clip map, source links, edit brief, thumbnail direction, and upload copy.
Creator	Approve topic, script direction, sensitive claims, final edit, title, thumbnail, and upload.	Taste decisions and final go/no-go.
Editing tools	Download permitted clips, organize files, assemble rough cut, add sound, captions, graphics, and exports.	Final long video, Shorts, thumbnail, and upload-ready files.

2. Step-by-Step Workflow

1. Trend Radar

Track competitor uploads, World Cup fixtures, transfers, player debates, fan arguments, and rising searches. The agent turns this into a ranked shortlist of video ideas.

2. Idea Validation

Check whether the topic has urgency, emotional tension, a clear thesis, available clips, and a thumbnail that can be understood instantly.

3. Title and Thumbnail Direction

Create title options and thumbnail concepts before writing the full script. If the video cannot be packaged clearly, it should not be produced yet.

4. Research Dossier

Collect facts, timelines, stats, quotes, interviews, press conferences, and counterarguments. Every major claim should have a source or clear evidence path.

5. Script Draft

Write the narration with a strong opening claim, clear chapters, retention hooks, and a memorable ending. The script can be dramatic, analytical, documentary-style, or punchier depending on the channel voice.

6. Clip Map

Break the script into exact visual needs. Every paragraph gets a visual instruction: quote clip, match b-roll, training footage, press photo, stat graphic, map, or backup visual.

7. Clip Collection

Find relevant clips, download permitted material with the available tools, label every asset, and record source links, timestamps, priority, and usage notes.

8. Voiceover and Edit Brief

Generate or prepare the narration, then create an editor-ready timeline with pacing notes, suggested visuals, captions, music mood, sound effects, and retention beats.

9. Upload Package

Prepare final title, description, tags, chapters, pinned comment, thumbnail notes, Shorts cutdowns, and a post-publish review checklist.

3. Clip Sourcing Workflow

Clip sourcing should start from the script, not from random browsing. The agent converts each script section into a precise clip request, then searches for the fastest useful way to visualize that moment.

Clip type	Best sources	How the agent speeds it up
Specific quote	Press conferences, podcasts, Sky/TNT/talkSPORT clips, club interviews, FIFA/UEFA channels, and player media days.	Searches exact phrases, finds likely videos, records timestamps, and suggests how the quote fits the edit.
Football b-roll	Official club channels, training footage, tunnel cams, open training, media days, and usable fan footage.	Builds source lists by player/team, labels footage by mood and use case, and creates backup visuals.
Match context	Official highlights, league channels, tactical boards, photos, stats pages, lineup graphics, maps, and tables.	Identifies the minimum footage needed and suggests transformative overlays, captions, and graphics.
Story evidence	News reports, old interviews, manager comments, player quotes, historical clips, and official announcements.	Builds the proof chain so the video feels researched rather than generic.

Recommended clip map columns

- Script section: where the visual appears in the narration.
- Clip needed: the exact person, moment, quote, match, or b-roll required.
- Source link: the original page or video where the clip came from.
- Timestamp: start and end time for the relevant moment.
- Priority: A, B, or C depending on how essential the clip is.
- Backup visual: still photo, stat graphic, map, quote card, or training b-roll.
- Usage note: how the editor should use it: hook, proof, transition, joke, payoff, or background.

4. Video Package Folder

Each video should live in its own folder. This keeps the project clean and makes it easy to know what is ready, what needs approval, and what still needs sourcing.

Folder or file	What goes inside
01 idea brief.md	Topic thesis, why now, target viewer, competitor proof, title options, and thumbnail direction.
02 research dossier.md	Facts, sources, quotes, timelines, statistics, player/team context, and counterarguments.
03 script.md	Final narration script with chapter breaks and pacing notes.
04 clip map.csv	Every visual needed, source links, timestamps, backup visuals, and usage notes.
05 edit brief.md	Timeline, b-roll order, caption notes, music mood, sound design, and retention beats.
06 thumbnail title package.md	Thumbnail concepts, title options, final description, chapters, tags, and pinned comment.
assets/raw	Downloaded source clips, photos, audio, graphics, and references.
assets/selected	Only the clips that make it into the edit.
exports	Final video, Shorts, thumbnail, and upload-ready files.

5. Quality and Safety Checks

Football content often uses broadcast footage, interviews, and third-party media. The workflow should include a simple review step before publishing to reduce copyright, misinformation, and quality issues.

- Use clips to support commentary, analysis, criticism, news reporting, or explanation rather than as filler.
- Keep match footage short, transformed, and surrounded by original narration, graphics, captions, or analysis.
- Prefer official training clips, press conferences, interviews, stills, and self-made graphics where possible.
- Record source links and timestamps for every clip so the edit remains traceable.
- Flag claims that need stronger sourcing before recording the final voiceover.
- Keep titles and thumbnails dramatic but accurate.

6. Example Video Workflow

Working topic: The World Cup Has A SERIOUS Norway Problem

Stage	Agent output	Creator decision
Idea	Explains why Norway is timely: Haaland, Odegaard, World Cup danger-team angle, and strong thumbnail potential.	Approve or reject topic.
Research	Collects group context, recent form, player roles, quotes, stats, and tactical points.	Approve argument and sensitive claims.
Script	Writes 10 to 14 minute narration with hook, chapters, evidence, twist, and final verdict.	Approve tone and factual framing.
Clips	Finds Haaland, Odegaard, Norway training, manager quotes, opposition visuals, maps, and backup graphics.	Approve must-use or avoid clips.
Edit	Creates timeline: hook montage, quote cards, b-roll sections, stat graphics, and sound notes.	Review rough cut.
Packaging	Creates title options, thumbnail direction, description, chapters, tags, pinned comment, and Shorts ideas.	Pick final title and thumbnail.
Upload	Prepares upload checklist and metadata. With account access, the agent can help move assets toward publishing.	Final publish approval.

7. What Can Be Automated First

Automation level	Tasks
Immediate	Competitor tracking, topic shortlist, title generation, script drafting, clip search queries, source logging, edit briefs, and upload copy.
Next	Semi-automated clip downloading, asset naming, voiceover generation, rough timeline creation, thumbnail draft generation, and Shorts selection.
Later	Full upload preparation, recurring trend monitors, automated competitor reports, performance feedback loop, and title/thumbnail testing library.

The long-term system should learn from each upload. After publishing, the agent reviews views, retention clues, click-through signals, comments, and competitor reactions, then recommends the next videos.

8. Workflow Diagram

Use this as the simple operating map for every video. The process loops after publishing because each upload teaches the channel what to make next.

Step	Agent work	Creator decision
1. Trend Radar	Monitor competitors, fixtures, transfers, player debates, and fast-moving football narratives.	Choose whether the topic fits the channel.
2. Idea Validation	Check urgency, emotional hook, clip availability, title potential, and thumbnail strength.	Approve the video angle.
3. Research Dossier	Collect sources, quotes, statistics, match context, interviews, and counterarguments.	Approve the thesis and sensitive claims.
4. Script	Write the full narration with hook, chapters, retention beats, and final payoff.	Approve voice, tone, and structure.
5. Clip Map	Turn every script section into a visual request with source links, timestamps, and backups.	Mark must-use and avoid clips.
6. Clip Collection	Find and download relevant clips using available tools, then label and organize assets.	Review key assets if needed.
7. Voice and Edit Brief	Prepare voiceover and an editor-ready timeline with b-roll, captions, graphics, and sound notes.	Approve rough cut direction.
8. Thumbnail and Title	Create title options, thumbnail concepts, description, tags, chapters, and pinned comment.	Pick final packaging.
9. Upload and Review	Prepare the upload package and review performance after publishing.	Approve publish and next-video direction.